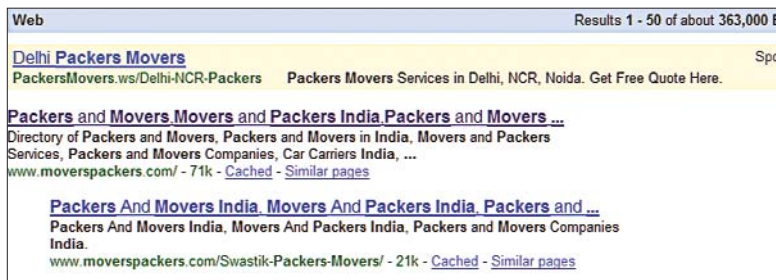


Often, search engines do not crawl very deep into your site; you can remedy this by submitting your site and the deeper pages in your site directly. Go to <http://google.com/Webmasters/tools> for Google, <http://siteexplorer.search.yahoo.com> for Yahoo!, and to <http://search.msn.com.sg/docs/submit.aspx> for Windows Live. Also, create a site map based on the XML Site Map standard—which is supported by the Big Three and others. There are many free tools that can quickly generate an XML sitemap of your site (search for “XML Sitemap Generator”). Create a folder called “public_html” in the root folder of your Web site, put the sitemap.xml file there, and submit the URL of the xml file to the search engines. This way, the spider will crawl the entire site and index all the pages. One added benefit is that when your site does come up as the first result in SERPs, it will automatically show the internal links under the main result heading, making it easier for users to quickly reach your internal pages faster.



Results for “packers movers india”. The result pages are chock full of permutations of those keywords! While this may seem to work, you could be penalised

Formatting And Keyword Density

While we did imply at the outset that META tags are no longer relevant, it still carries a little weight. The meta tag of a page indicates some basic information about your page. For example...

```
<meta name="Description" content="Website for Indian Motorcycle Fans." />
```

```
<meta name="Keywords" content="india,motorcycles,hero honda,bajaj, bullet, royal enfield " />
```

...is an example of a good meta tag. The keywords can, of course, be expanded, but ideally should be kept to the bare minimum and only include those important words that appear in the content. In addition, ensure that the Title tag of your page corresponds to the title of the content of the page. This informs the search engine that your Web page is what it claims to be.

You can also use different fonts and formatting for specific keywords. Search engines will give different weightage for words that are bolded or underlined, and will give different weightage for bolded or underlined links. Needless to say, this has to be in context. You can't bold all the text! The search engine will take this as the standard formatting for the page.

The formatting you apply should be primarily designed to inform the human reader of different levels of emphasis that you wish to apply. Also, for images, include anchor text (alt text) that gives a description for the image rather than just the image name.

In addition to applying formatting that can help increase the weightage of your pages, you should also keep keyword density in mind. The keyword density is the ratio of the total number of keywords to the total number of words. There is no magic number for this; it keeps changing constantly and may be different for different industries. One way is to run a search with the keywords and look at the density in the top 10 sites in the SERP and determine a density somewhat midway between the highest and lowest values. You might want to do the same for the keywords themselves—see what the competition is using!

Now for the bad news. While optimum keyword density may not be given a great deal of weight by the search engine, too high a figure for keyword density can attract penalties—search engines may rightly or wrongly suspect you of keyword stuffing.

Keep your keywords focused. If you are a packer and mover in India, keep your words limited to “packer mover india”; Google, in any case, clumps words with similar meanings together. You might consider using related keywords like “point-to-point shipping”, “door delivery”, etc.

Site And Page Age

This is a simple but important metric. The longer the site has been running and the longer the page has been up, search engines give it a better ranking on the assumption that you are not a fly-by-night operator and have really something useful to say. The same can be said for links. The longer someone links to your page, the more it gains in value.

The search engines apply, to varying degrees, an aging delay on new Web sites. This is based on the assumption that sites are trying to game the search algorithm, and they are progressively removed over a period of time. From an optimisation perspective there is nothing you can do about it but wait. So if your pages do not start appearing in the search results straightaway and you are a fairly new site, you know why!

Going To The Professionals

The SEO industry being what it is, there are as many con artists as there are genuine practitioners of the craft. In most cases, by simply focusing on delivering great content and by following the basic rules to prevent you from getting blacklisted—along with some light PR linking activity in relevant blogs and forums—will enable your site to gradually rise up the rankings. However, if you need results, and fast, you should turn to an SEO Professional. A true SEO consultant can deliver superior results to what you could achieve on your own. However, given the prevalence of so many con artists who make your contract contingent on specific benchmarks, you need to define the search keywords that you wish to rank in, specify the ranking range that you want to appear in (if they promise to deliver number 1 ranking, politely thank them and slam the door in their face), and specify the time period that this must happen in. Only after you define at least these three metrics should you even consider inking a deal. ☒

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